```
*/
public function getAccountNumber(){
return $this->accountNumber;
}

/**
* set bank account number
* @param string $accountNumber
*/
public function setAccountNumber($accountNumber){
$this->accountNumber = $accountNumber;
 }
}
```

Notice that we used a special $this variable to access a property of an object. PHP uses the $this variable to refer to the current object.

To access a property you use the arrow (->) operator as follows:

```
object->property
```

Let's examine the BankAccount's methods in greater detail:

- The deposit() method increases the total balance of the account.
- The withdraw() method checks the available balance. If the total balance is less than the amount to be withdrew, it issues an error message, otherwise it decreases the total balance.
- The getBalance() method returns the total balance of the account.
- The setAccountNumber() and getAccountNumber() methods are called *setter*/*getter*methods.

Keyword

Parenthesis is a tall, curvy punctuation mark used to set off material that isn't fundamental to the main topic, like an afterthought or an aside.

Calling Methods

To call a method of an object, you use the (->) operator followed by the method name and **parentheses**. Let's call the methods of the bank account class: